

PROFESSIONAL AI WORK INSTRUCTION FRAMEWORK

The One Prompt Framework You Actually Need

A professional, reusable framework for turning vague requests into structured AI work instructions.

S

One framework. Five control blocks. Almost any work task.

Use SCOPE for project updates, decisions, analysis, client communication, research, planning, vendor comparison, and repeatable operational work.

For project managers, consultants, real estate professionals, operations teams, and small businesses.

AI+PM LAB

A Trigosat Consulting initiative.

Practical AI workflows. Clear operations. Human control.

CLARITY helps you think. SCOPE turns that thinking into a reusable instruction.

The CLARITY Checklist and the SCOPE Framework are designed to work together, but they solve different problems.

RESOURCE	PRIMARY JOB	BEST MOMENT TO USE IT
Before You Prompt - CLARITY Checklist	Check whether the request has enough context, audience, purpose, inputs, boundaries, format, and quality criteria.	Before drafting the final instruction.
The One Prompt Framework - SCOPE	Assemble the work into one structured, repeatable AI instruction with a defined outcome and review gate.	When the task needs to be executed, reviewed, saved, or reused.

The operating sequence

1	CLARITY Clarify the work before asking AI to act.
2	SCOPE Convert the brief into a complete work instruction.
3	HUMAN REVIEW Verify facts, authority, risk, and usability.
4	REPEATABLE WORKFLOW Save the instruction, assign ownership, and connect it to the next step.
→	The distinction matters A checklist can improve a single prompt. A work instruction can become part of a controlled process that other people can understand, review, and reuse.

The real problem is not the prompt. It is the missing work instruction.

Most people ask AI to produce an output before they have defined the work. The model receives a request, but not the operational logic behind it.

IMPROVISED REQUEST	WHAT THE AI MUST GUESS
"Write a project update."	Audience, purpose, source notes, project status, tone, length, risks, decisions, and what should happen next.
"Compare these vendors."	Criteria, weights, missing information, approval limits, risk tolerance, and whether the recommendation is final or provisional.
"Follow up with the client."	Relationship stage, prior commitments, desired next action, facts that may be stated, tone, and deadline.

Four consequences of weak instructions

- The output sounds polished but does not support the real decision or next action.
- Missing details are silently replaced with generic assumptions.
- The user rewrites the request each time, so quality and consistency vary.
- No one knows what to verify before the output enters a client, project, or operational workflow.

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Core principle

The quality of the output depends on the quality of the work instructions - not on how impressive the prompt sounds.

A professional prompt behaves like a compact operating brief.

The goal is not to make every request long. The goal is to make every important instruction complete enough to execute and review.

PROMPT IMPROVED	PROFESSIONAL WORK INSTRUCTION
Describes a general task.	Defines the result, the audience, and how the result will be used.
Leaves context implicit.	States the situation, approved inputs, and relevant project or process stage.
Says "make it professional."	Specifies operating steps, criteria, boundaries, tone, and format.
Accepts the output as finished.	Requires missing information, assumptions, risks, and human approval points to be surfaced.
Is rewritten from scratch.	Can be saved, adapted, delegated, and inserted into a repeatable workflow.

A work instruction should answer five questions

1. What situation is the work responding to?
2. What specific result should the AI produce or support?
3. How should the work be performed?
4. What boundaries, constraints, and format must be respected?
5. How will the output be evaluated before use?

5

What changes

You stop treating AI like a blank chat box and start treating the instruction as part of the operating system around the work.

The SCOPE Framework

Five control blocks for turning almost any work request into a clear, reviewable AI instruction.

S	SITUATION Contextualize the work: what is happening, who is involved, and what information is available.
C	CLEAR OUTCOME Define the result and the decision, action, or communication it should support.
O	OPERATING INSTRUCTIONS Explain how the AI should perform the work and which criteria or sequence it should use.
P	PARAMETERS Set format, tone, limits, privacy rules, deadlines, and decision boundaries.
E	EVALUATION Require the AI to check completeness, identify gaps, separate facts from assumptions, and flag human review.
✓	Why SCOPE works It combines the three things most prompts miss: an operational outcome, explicit execution rules, and a final evaluation step.

Memory line

Situation → Clear Outcome → Operating Instructions → Parameters → Evaluation

S - Situation

Give the AI the operational context it cannot safely infer.

Situation describes the current state of the work. It is more than background: it establishes the project stage, the audience, the source material, and the reason the output is needed now.

Include

- The project, client, process, or business situation.
- The person who will read, use, approve, or act on the output.
- What has already happened, been decided, or been ruled out.
- The notes, data, documents, examples, policies, or prior decisions available.
- Dependencies, timing, or constraints that materially change the task.

WEAK SITUATION	USEFUL SITUATION
"We need a status update."	"The implementation is in week 6. Testing is two days behind, the client expects a Friday update, and the project manager needs approval on the revised training date. Use the attached issue log and milestone notes."

Questions to answer

[]	What event, request, stage, or problem created this work?
[]	Who will use the result, and what do they already know?
[]	Which information is approved for use?
[]	What decision, deadline, or dependency makes the task important now?

S	Common mistake Do not overload the AI with every historical detail. Include the information that changes the result, the decision, or the level of risk.
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C - Clear Outcome

Define what should be different after the output is used.

An output is a deliverable. An outcome is what the deliverable must enable. The outcome tells the AI which information matters and how direct the result should be.

DELIVERABLE ONLY	CLEAR OUTCOME
"Write an email."	"Obtain confirmation of the revised meeting date by Thursday without reopening decisions that were already approved."
"Create a report."	"Give the steering committee enough evidence to decide whether the pilot should continue for another 30 days."
"Compare options."	"Recommend a provisional supplier for negotiation while clearly showing what information remains unverified."

A useful outcome identifies

- The decision, action, approval, understanding, or communication the result should support.
- The reader or operator who must be able to use it.
- What success looks like after the output enters the workflow.
- What should not happen, such as creating alarm, making an unauthorized promise, or presenting a provisional recommendation as final.

C	Outcome formula
	Create [DELIVERABLE] so that [LISTENER] can [DECIDE / ACT / UNDERSTAND / APPROVE] while [IMPORTANT LIMIT OR RELATIONSHIP CONDITION].
[]	What should the reader know or do next?
[]	What decision should this output prepare or support?
[]	How will the result be used in the real process?
[]	What negative outcome should the instruction avoid?

O - Operating Instructions

Tell the AI how to perform the work, not only what to produce.

Operating Instructions define the method. They establish the sequence, analytical criteria, required inclusions, and how uncertainty should be handled.

Use operating instructions to specify

- The steps the AI should follow before presenting the final result.
- The criteria, framework, priority order, or decision logic to use.
- The sections, issues, risks, owners, or evidence that must be included.
- How conflicting inputs or missing data should be treated.
- What the AI may recommend and what it must leave for human judgment.

WEAK INSTRUCTION

Analyze the project and tell me what to do.

CONTROLLED INSTRUCTION

1. Summarize confirmed progress against the approved milestones.
2. Identify variances and their likely operational impact.
3. Separate active issues from future risks.
4. Show decisions required from the project manager.
5. Do not assign new deadlines or owners unless they are present in the source material.

Strong verbs for operating instructions

ANALYSIS	ORGANIZATION	CONTROL
Compare, classify, calculate, test, prioritize, trace	Separate, group, sequence, summarize, map, convert	Flag, verify, label, exclude, escalate, stop, request confirmation

O

Common mistake

Do not prescribe a complicated method when a simple result is enough. Add operating steps only when they improve accuracy, consistency, or reviewability.

P - Parameters

Set the boundaries that make the output safe and usable.

Parameters define the form of the answer and the limits of the AI's authority. They reduce rework and prevent the output from drifting beyond the real task.

PARAMETER	EXAMPLES
Format	Email, decision brief, table, checklist, action plan, executive summary, agenda, SOP.
Structure	Required headings, columns, sequence, number of options, separate assumptions section.
Length and tone	150 words, one page, executive, plain language, neutral, warm but direct.
Time and cost	Deadline, budget ceiling, available hours, approval threshold, implementation window.
Data and privacy	Use only approved sources; remove personal data; do not expose client or employee information.
Decision boundary	AI may draft or recommend; a named human role must approve commitments, budgets, legal statements, staffing, or safety decisions.

PARAMETER EXAMPLE

Return a one-page table with: issue, evidence, impact, proposed action, owner, and deadline. Use a neutral executive tone. Do not exceed the approved \$5,000 budget. Do not include employee names. Put any recommendation that changes scope in a separate "Approval required" section.

P

Parameters are not decoration

A word limit saves time. A decision boundary protects authority. A source restriction protects accuracy. A privacy rule protects people and the organization.

E - Evaluation

Require the AI to check the result before you review it.

Evaluation is the control block that most generic prompting frameworks omit. It does not replace human review, but it makes gaps and risks more visible before the output is used.

A strong evaluation instruction asks the AI to

- Check whether the result answers the stated outcome.
- Identify missing, conflicting, outdated, or unverifiable information.
- Separate confirmed facts, assumptions, analysis, and recommendations.
- Show risks, limitations, and tradeoffs that may affect the decision.
- List the points that require human verification or approval.
- Recommend the next action only within the defined authority boundary.

REUSABLE EVALUATION BLOCK

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Before presenting the final result:  
- verify that every required element is present;  
- label facts, assumptions, and recommendations;  
- list missing or conflicting information;  
- identify risks and limitations;  
- flag any statement, number, commitment, or decision that requires human verification.  
Present the result, then "Points to confirm" and "Recommended next action."
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E

Important limit

An AI self-check can improve visibility. It cannot prove that the model is correct. High-impact facts and decisions must still be checked against authoritative sources by an accountable person.

The SCOPE Quick Prompt

Use this compact version for routine work when the inputs are clear and the impact is low to medium.

SCOPE - QUICK VERSION

SITUATION

I am working on: [SITUATION / PROJECT / PROCESS].
The result is for: [LISTENER / USER / APPROVER].
Use these approved inputs: [NOTES / DATA / DOCUMENTS].

CLEAR OUTCOME

Create: [DELIVERABLE].
It should help the listener: [DECIDE / ACT / UNDERSTAND / APPROVE].

OPERATING INSTRUCTIONS

Follow these steps or criteria: [METHOD / PRIORITIES / MUST-HAVES].
Flag missing information. Do not invent facts.

PARAMETERS

Format: [STRUCTURE]. Tone and length: [STYLE / LIMIT].
Respect: [BUDGET / DEADLINE / PRIVACY / AUTHORITY / EXCLUSIONS].

EVALUATION

Before finalizing, check completeness, separate facts from assumptions, list risks or limitations, and identify anything requiring human verification.

Return:

1. The requested result
2. Points to confirm
3. Recommended next action

When to use the Quick Version

- Routine professional emails and follow-ups.
- Meeting recaps and internal summaries.
- First drafts of checklists, briefs, agendas, or action plans.
- Low-risk analysis where the source material is already complete.

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Before the output

For a complex task, add: "Before producing the result, ask up to five questions that would materially improve accuracy or usability. Do not ask for information already provided."

The Professional SCOPE Master Prompt

Use the full version for project work, client deliverables, analysis, decisions, or any output that may create commitments or be reused by a team.

PROFESSIONAL SCOPE MASTER PROMPT

You are supporting [ROLE / TEAM / FUNCTION] with a professional work task.

S - SITUATION

Current situation: [PROJECT / PROCESS / CLIENT / BUSINESS CONTEXT].
 Listener or user of the result: [ROLE, KNOWLEDGE, CONCERNS, AUTHORITY].
 Approved inputs: [NOTES / DATA / DOCUMENTS / POLICIES / EXAMPLES].
 Relevant history, dependencies, and timing: [DETAILS].

C - CLEAR OUTCOME

Required deliverable: [OUTPUT].
 The result must help [LISTENER] to [DECIDE / ACT / UNDERSTAND / APPROVE].
 Success means: [PRACTICAL OUTCOME].
 Avoid causing: [UNWANTED OUTCOME].

O - OPERATING INSTRUCTIONS

1. [FIRST STEP OR ANALYSIS].
 2. [SECOND STEP OR ORGANIZATION].
 3. [THIRD STEP OR RECOMMENDATION].
 Use these criteria: [PRIORITIES / FRAMEWORK / WEIGHTS / ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA].
 Include: [REQUIRED ELEMENTS].
 When information is missing or conflicts, label it "To confirm." Do not invent details.

P - PARAMETERS

Format and structure: [FORMAT / SECTIONS / COLUMNS].
 Tone, language, and length: [REQUIREMENTS].
 Constraints: [BUDGET / TIME / POLICY / PRIVACY / EXCLUSIONS].
 Decision boundary: [WHAT AI MAY SUGGEST; WHAT REQUIRES HUMAN APPROVAL].

E - EVALUATION

Before finalizing:

- verify alignment with the clear outcome;
- check that every fact and number is traceable to the approved inputs;
- separate facts, assumptions, analysis, and recommendations;
- list missing information, risks, limitations, and tradeoffs;
- identify commitments or decisions requiring human verification.

Present:

1. The requested deliverable
2. Points to confirm
3. Risks and limitations
4. Recommended next action

Save it as a template

Replace the brackets once for a recurring task, then store the approved version in your team's prompt library, SOP, project workspace, or workflow documentation.

Project management: weekly steering update

This example converts mixed status notes into a decision-focused update for a steering committee.

VAGUE REQUEST

VAGUE REQUEST

Write a weekly project update for management.

SOURCE NOTES

APPROVED SOURCE NOTES

- Data migration: 72% complete; two days behind baseline.
- Training materials: draft complete; legal review due Wednesday.
- Vendor API defect: workaround tested; permanent fix estimated next week.
- Budget: 61% spent; project timeline is 65% complete.
- Decision needed: approve weekend migration testing or accept a three-day schedule risk.
- No approved change to launch date.

SCOPE PROMPT

You are supporting the project manager of a system implementation.

Situation: The project is 65% through the approved timeline. Use only the status notes below. The result is for a steering committee that needs a concise view of progress, risks, and decisions.

Clear Outcome: Prepare a weekly update that enables the committee to decide whether to approve weekend migration testing. Do not imply that the launch date has changed.

Operating Instructions: Summarize progress against workstreams; identify schedule and delivery risks; separate issues already controlled from decisions still open; show the decision required and its operational tradeoff.

Parameters: Return a one-page executive brief with: overall status, milestone progress, issues, risks, decision required, next seven-day actions, owner, and deadline. Neutral tone. Do not invent percentages, dates, costs, or commitments.

Evaluation: Verify every statement against the notes. Label assumptions. List missing information and anything requiring project manager confirmation.

SCOPE CONTROL	WHAT IT IMPROVES
Situation + Outcome	Makes the steering decision - not the status narrative - the center of the update.
Instructions + Parameters	Creates a predictable executive structure with no invented commitments.
Evaluation	Surfaces gaps before the update is circulated.

Real estate: post-showing buyer follow-up

The instruction preserves the relationship, distinguishes stated preferences from assumptions, and ends with a clear next step.

SITUATION NOTES

APPROVED NOTES

- Buyer toured a two-bedroom condo in Astoria.
- Buyer liked natural light and kitchen condition.
- Concerns: second bedroom size and monthly common charges.
- Buyer asked whether the seller has flexibility but did not state an offer amount.
- Buyer is also viewing another property Saturday.
- Agent has no confirmed information about seller flexibility.

SCOPE PROMPT

You are supporting a NYC real estate agent after a buyer showing.

Situation: Use only the approved showing notes. The listener is a buyer who is interested but comparing another property and has concerns about space and monthly costs.

Clear Outcome: Send a professional follow-up that confirms the buyer's priorities, maintains momentum, and obtains permission to discuss the next step after Saturday's showing.

Operating Instructions: Mention the features and concerns the buyer explicitly stated. Ask one clear question about the importance of the second bedroom versus the overall property. Acknowledge the question about seller flexibility without implying knowledge that is not confirmed.

Parameters: Warm, concise email of 130-160 words. Do not suggest an offer amount, guarantee flexibility, add market statistics, or pressure the buyer. End with one specific next-step question.

Evaluation: Check that every property or buyer statement comes from the notes. Separate known facts from items the agent would need to verify. Flag any sentence that could be interpreted as a promise.

Why this is stronger than “write a follow-up”

[]	It defines the relationship goal, not only the email.
[]	It prevents invented seller information or market claims.
[]	It uses the buyer's own stated priorities.
[]	It creates a natural, specific next step without pressure.

H

Human review point
The agent remains responsible for property facts, fair-housing compliance, representations, negotiation strategy, and any statement that may influence a transaction decision.

Operations: compare three vendors and prepare a provisional recommendation

This example demonstrates how SCOPE can organize evidence without turning the AI into the final decision-maker.

AVAILABLE INFORMATION

VENDOR FACTS

Vendor A: \$18,500; 6-week delivery; 24-month warranty; two references.
 Vendor B: \$16,900; 8-week delivery; 12-month warranty; implementation support included; security questionnaire incomplete.
 Vendor C: \$20,200; 5-week delivery; 36-month warranty; strongest service-level agreement; one reference not yet contacted.
 Budget ceiling without executive approval: \$19,000.
 Required go-live: within 7 weeks.
 Weights: delivery 30%, cost 25%, service/support 20%, risk/compliance 15%, warranty 10%.

SCOPE PROMPT

Act as an operations analyst preparing a vendor decision brief.

Situation: Compare Vendors A, B, and C using only the facts provided. The result is for an operations director who may negotiate but cannot approve spending above \$19,000.

Clear Outcome: Identify the strongest provisional option for negotiation while showing the evidence, tradeoffs, and missing information that could change the decision.

Operating Instructions: Score each vendor against the approved weights. Show the calculation method. Treat missing compliance or reference information as unresolved risk, not as a zero or a pass. Explain any option that fails the budget or 7-week go-live constraint.

Parameters: Return: weighted comparison table, constraint check, risk summary, provisional recommendation, negotiation priorities, and "Information required before approval." Do not invent features or normalize missing data without explanation.

Evaluation: Recalculate all weighted totals, identify sensitivity to missing information, separate the analytical recommendation from the human approval decision, and flag any executive approval required.

CONTROL BUILT INTO THE PROMPT	OPERATIONAL VALUE
Approved weights	The recommendation can be audited instead of relying on an unexplained preference.
Constraint check	A high score cannot silently override budget or delivery requirements.
Missing-data rule	Incomplete compliance and reference information stays visible.
Decision boundary	The AI prepares the decision; the accountable director approves it.

Before You Use the Output

Use this gate after the AI responds and before the result enters a client, project, operational, or public workflow.

[]	The output clearly supports the outcome stated in the prompt.
[]	Every fact, number, date, calculation, name, and commitment has been checked.
[]	The AI did not add information that was not present in the approved inputs.
[]	Confirmed facts, assumptions, analysis, and recommendations are visibly separated.
[]	Missing or conflicting information is identified instead of silently resolved.
[]	The result respects privacy, confidentiality, policy, and role-based access requirements.
[]	No recommendation creates a budget, scope, staffing, legal, safety, or client commitment beyond the reviewer's authority.
[]	The accountable person is clear, and the approval is documented where the impact requires it.
[]	The output is usable in the next workflow step without unnecessary rewriting or interpretation.

Choose the minimum review level

LEVEL	EXAMPLES	MINIMUM REVIEW
LOW	Brainstorming, outline, internal draft	Quick human sense-check.
MEDIUM	Client email, project update, vendor analysis	Source check and approval by the work owner.
HIGH	Contracts, budgets, staffing, safety, legal, financial, or compliance decisions	Qualified review, authoritative-source verification, and documented approval.

H

Remember

AI can prepare the work. It should not silently own the decision, the relationship, the authority, or the consequences.

Build your next SCOPE instruction on one page.

Write one or two precise lines for each block. Then copy the answers into the Quick Prompt or Professional Master Prompt.

S

SITUATION - What is happening? Who will use the result? What approved information is available?

C

CLEAR OUTCOME - What deliverable is needed, and what decision, action, or understanding should it support?

O

OPERATING INSTRUCTIONS - What steps, criteria, inclusions, or method should the AI use?

P

PARAMETERS - What format, tone, length, deadline, budget, privacy rule, exclusion, or authority limit applies?

E

EVALUATION - How should the AI check completeness, assumptions, risks, missing information, and human review?

ASSEMBLE THE QUICK PROMPT

Situation: [S]. Outcome: [C]. Instructions: [O]. Parameters: [P]. Evaluation: [E]. Flag missing information and do not invent facts.

A good prompt improves one result. A controlled workflow improves the work every time.

Once a SCOPE instruction works, do not leave it in a private chat. Turn it into a reusable operating asset.

Turn the prompt into a workflow

1	SAVE Store the approved instruction with a clear name, owner, purpose, and version.
2	CONNECT Define where the inputs come from and where the output must go next.
3	REVIEW Assign the human check appropriate to the impact of the work.
4	MEASURE Track rework, response time, quality issues, exceptions, and user feedback.
5	IMPROVE Update the instruction when the process, policy, source data, or decision criteria change.
1	Free mini workflow review AI+PM Lab is offering a limited number of free mini workflow reviews for professionals and small teams. Share one recurring task or process and receive practical ideas to make it clearer, faster, more consistent, or easier to control. The only request is a few minutes of honest feedback.

What to bring

[]	One task or workflow that currently feels repetitive, manual, unclear, or difficult to track.
[]	A simple explanation of how it is handled today - no confidential information required.
[]	The result you want to improve: speed, quality, consistency, visibility, follow-up, or control.

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